
Introduction

You are

at the beginning of the participation path, the phase that follows the design stage. The execution of the (educational) project is now about to begin.

Remember the Core Values

The practice of transdisciplinary education comes in as many versions as there are projects, full of practical doubts and challenges. Especially when such problems arise, it is important to recall the core values. Think back to what stayed with you from the beginning of the TRAIL. Making progress on complex societal issues, strengthening future-proof education, and hearing the voices of all involved requires genuine interest in other participants and equality among team members.

Under the **theory tab**, you'll find more reflections on recruitment and creating a safe learning environment, while the **practice tab** leads to a tip for a practical tool to help you get off to a strong start in the co-creation process.

Theory

Recruitment

Before we begin, the first step is recruiting project participants, insofar as the full team has not yet been formed during the foundational or design phase. You can recruit based on background (disciplines), motivation, or grades (in the case of students). Motivation is an important criterion, based on the idea that

every voice holds value in transdisciplinary knowledge, and therefore every motivated participant should be given the opportunity to take part in transdisciplinary education.

Safe Learning Environment

When we actually come together, you truly feel the journey progressing—an exciting reality. According to the core values of transdisciplinarity, we must ensure mutual trust and freedom for everyone. Creating a safe learning environment is essential for successful transdisciplinary collaboration (i.e. Yeung et al., 2021).

On the next page below, lessons from the TRAIL research and the *Practical Guide to Transdisciplinary Collaboration* (Het Groene Brein, 2023) will help you get started.

Co-creation

After the start, you'll quickly discover the challenges in the practical organization of collaboration. The presence of many different team members also means many different agendas, meetings, and preferences to consider. To keep the collaboration on track and maintain momentum, various tools are available. No one said it would be easy—but that's exactly why we're entering the most exciting phase of this adventure.

More theoretical insights on this topic will follow.

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References:

Het Groene Brein. (2023). *Praktijkgids Transdisciplinair Werken: Tips en gereedschappen voor succesvol samenwerken bij de cocreatie van kennis en toepassingen*. Het Groene Brein & Community Sociaal Circulair.

Yeung, E., Carlin, L., Sandassie, S., & Jaglal, S. (2021). Transdisciplinary training: what does it take to address today's "wicked problems"? *Innovation and Education*, 3(1), 1-8.

Practice

The Learning Community Tool is a clear and insightful tool for developing co-creation. This tool suggests, among other things, scheduling weekly team meetings, creating a mixed community based on five design principles, and using concrete and existing collaboration tools—TRAIL also offers inspiration for this.